

## **Biodiversity**

**Sub-theme title:** Biodiversity: Life, Technology and a Sustainable Future

### **Concept Note:**

Biodiversity is the foundation of life on Earth, encompassing the rich variety of microorganisms, plants, fungi, animals, and ecosystems that sustain ecological balance and human well-being. It provides essential ecosystem services, food security, climate resilience, and sustainable livelihoods. However, biodiversity is increasingly threatened by habitat loss, climate change, pollution, invasive species, and unsustainable resource use. Conserving this invaluable natural heritage requires the integration of classical biological sciences with modern tools such as genomics, biotechnology, artificial intelligence, remote sensing, and bioinformatics. Collaborative research, technological innovation, and community participation are vital to advancing biodiversity conservation, ecosystem restoration, and sustainable development for future generations.

### **Plenary Speaker:**

1. **Prof. Chakravarthula Manoharachary, Professor of Botany Department of Botany Osmania University, India**

**Title of Talk: Microbial and Technological innovations : Cross disciplinary pathways to Human Welfare and Environmental Sustainability**

2. **Prof. Sushil Kumar Dutta, Utkal University, Odisha, India**

**Title of Talk: Why we find so many undescribed amphibians in India?**

### **Invited Speaker:**

1. **Prof. Pradipta Mahapatra, Department of Botany, Ravenshaw University**

**Title of Talk: Photosynthetic pigment fluorescence for analysis of biotic abiotic stress in plants**

2. **Dr. Atanu Raha, Retired Indian Forest Service (IFS) officer, Govt. of West Bengal & Emeritus Professor, Techno India University Salt Lake.**

**Title of Talk: Mitigating the impact of Climate Change on a World Heritage site - the participatory way**

### **National/International Advisory Committee Members (3–4 Members)**

- Prof. Badal Kumar Dutta, Professor of Botany, Tripura University
- Prof. Alka Chturvedi, Professor of Botany, Nagpur University
- Prof. Pradipta Mahapatra, Department of Botany, Ravenshaw University
- Prof. V. S. Ramachandran, Professor of Botany, Bharathiar University, Coimbatore
- Prof. Arabind K. Dhabe, Professor of Botany, Dr. Babasaheb Ambedkar Marathwada University, Aurangabad
- Dr. Devendra Singh, Scientist-F, Botanical Survey of India

- Prof. J. Potts, University of South Carolina, USA.
- Prof. B. N. Pandey, Magadh University, Bihar.
- Prof. B.D. Joshi, Gurukul Kangri University, Uttarakhand.
- Prof. S. G. Pal, Calcutta University, West Bengal.
- Dr. P.K. Mukhopadhyay, CIFA, Odisha.